

Career change dilemma: From Sustainability to Data Center

Posted by u/stoicism27 • • 0 points • 1 comments

Hey everyone,
I'm in a bit of a career dilemma and would love some outside perspective.

I recently got referred by a friend to a data center construction company. They interviewed me and, despite the fact that I've never worked in data centers *or* construction, they're really interested in bringing me in. They specifically liked my background in energy/sustainability. For context: I'm currently, working in industrial projects for EVs and circular economy.

The position they're offering is both technical and client-facing, and it involves traveling to other countries to coordinate projects. They basically want someone who understands end-to-end processes, learns fast, and can communicate with suppliers/clients, and since I speak several languages, that's a plus for them.

Here's my dilemma:

On paper, the data center industry looks insanely promising But it's also a completely new domain for me. I've never worked in construction, and shifting industries always feels like starting over. Plus, I'm currently working for a very well known automobile manufacturer, but it is not very stimulating, and is the classic 'safe' corporate job.

Has anyone here made a similar switch from a big industrial company to a niche, high-growth industry?

Is construction/DC engineering a good long-term bet?

Any advice or personal experience is appreciated!

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-12-11 10:55 UTC

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u/maui-shark-fighter • 1 points • 2025-11-22 21:22 UTC

OMG GO! - Yes datacenters are taking off and huge opportunity and have fun travelling.

u/stoicism27 • 1 points • 2025-11-23 10:18 UTC

Last interview on thursday!, wish me luck :)

u/Skinnyflacko13 • 1 points • 2025-11-22 14:57 UTC

I am by no means a source of tech advise (I'm a lawyer by trade) who is also trying to learn about the data center space. But in a general sense, I think this rly depends on the type of lifestyle you have or what you are looking for (obviously lol). I think you clearly have the technical chops to succeed at the new role but there will be learning curve as an absorb new construction type info. But the industry is booming and while u might feel like you're starting over you'll actually be dealing with relatively novel issues where no one has immediate transferable experience. Everyone is figuring it out so have confidence and if your cool with the travel portion, shoot from the hip. Good luck!

u/stoicism27 • 2 points • 2025-11-23 10:20 UTC

I made up my mind and guess you're right new industry and missions/knowledge sounds like a fun challenge!

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-11-17 19:32 UTC

Hello! This looks like it may be a question about career advice. There can be significant regional variation in the field, so please consider including as much info as you can without doxing yourself, including country/state/city, prior experience/certs, and the role or level if known. Thanks!

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